

GHOSTBUSTERS, VIRGINIA

P.K.E.

INSTRUCTION MANUAL



FOR 1 PLAYER

16

GAMES

FOR THE ATARI 2600 VIDEO COMPUTER SYSTEM AND ATARI 2600+

ECTO-GAMES

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Based on characters created by Dan Aykroyd and Harold Ramis.

This project is created for non-commercial, entertainment purposes only.

Visit Ghostbusters, Virginia at <https://www.ghostbustersva.com> to learn more about the only 501(c)(3) charity recognized by Sony's Ghost Corps in Virginia that gives back to its community through a love of Ghostbusters.

NOTE: Always turn the console POWER switch OFF when inserting or removing an ATARI® Game Program™ cartridge. This will protect the electronic components and prolong the life of your ATARI® Video Computer System™ game.

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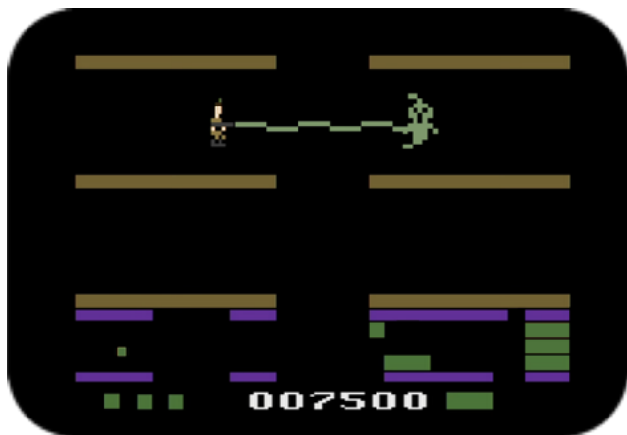
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P.K.E. INSTRUCTIONS

1. INTRODUCTION

"If there's something strange in the neighborhood, who ya gonna call?"

— Ray Parker, Jr.



The neighborhood library has a nasty case of spooks, specters, and ghosts haunting the stacks. It's your job, as head of the city's foremost Professional Paranormal Investigation and Elimination Service, to capture the ghosts without all your uniforms getting slimed!

2. USING THE CONTROLLERS

"We have the tools! We have the talent!" — Winston Zeddemore



Use the Joystick Controller with this ATARI® Game Program™ cartridge. Be sure the Joystick Controller cable is firmly plugged into the LEFT CONTROLLER jack at the back of your ATARI® Video Computer System™.

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Hold the Joystick Controller with the red button to your upper left, toward the television screen.

Move the Joystick Controller up, down, left, or right to maneuver the player on the screen. Avoid the ghosts and collect the bonuses.

Press the FIRE button to blast your Neutrona Wand.

3. CONSOLE CONTROLS

“Very simple, really. Loaded trap here. Open. Unlock the system. Insert the trap. Release. Close. Lock the system. Set your entry grid. Neutronize your field. And, when the light is green, the trap is clean.” — Dr. Ray Stantz



After powering on your ATARI® Video Computer System™, you will see the title and hear the theme music.

Press FIRE once to skip ahead to the Game Select Screen.

Either press the Game Select switch or move the Joystick up or down to choose the game variation.

The game variation number is displayed at the bottom of the screen.

Press the FIRE button to begin the selected game.

Sixteen game variations are available. Refer to the GAME SELECT MATRIX.

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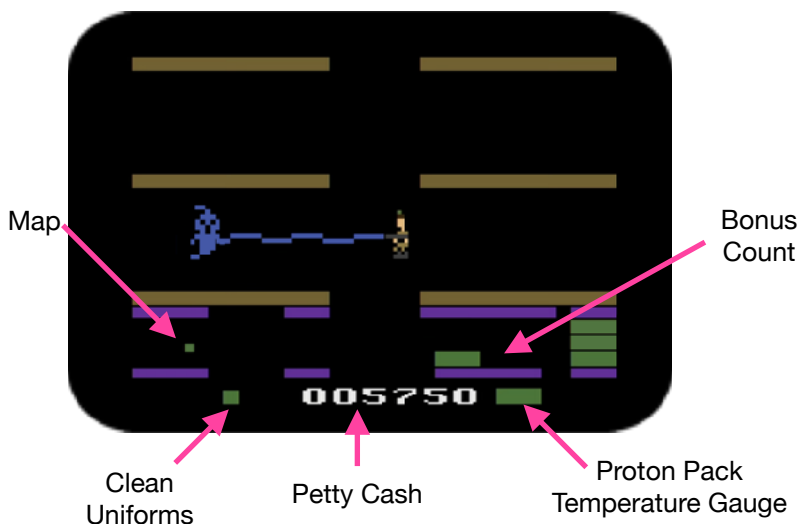
4. GAME PLAY

*"Why worry? Each of us is wearing an unlicensed nuclear accelerator on his back."
— Dr. Peter Venkman*

You are searching the library for ghosts. The Easy Layout takes place on the main floor of the library. The Complex Layout descends to the basement.

If the game variation selected includes the map, it is located at the left of the display. The blinking dot indicates the player's position within the library.

On the main floor, all the bookshelves run east-west with gaps allowing movement in any of the four directions. However, in the basement, shelves may also run north-south and some paths are blocked, resulting in a much more maze-like experience.



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Below the map, the remaining clean uniforms are displayed. Being touched by a ghost results in being slimed. When all four uniforms are slimed, the game is over.

In the bottom center of the panel, is your Petty Cash balance.

When you enter a screen with a ghost, find a position to safely fire the Neutrons Wand without being touched by the ghost.

The ghost weakens when struck by the stream from your Neutrons Wand. The ghost's color fades to white and then gray. Maintain the stream on the ghost until it is weak enough to be trapped. The ghost trap will automatically self-deploy when this point is reached.

Firing the wand causes the pack to heat up due to the generation of proton energy. The pack cools when not being fired. Monitor the pack temperature while firing the Neutrons Wand. The Temperature Gauge, an eight-segment bar graph, displays to the right of the Petty Cash display.

A green temperature gauge indicates safe operation. A yellow gauge indicates crossing the 50% threshold. A red gauge, along with an audible alarm, indicates the pack has overheated.

The DIFFICULTY switches determine how fast the pack will overheat or recover. If the LEFT DIFFICULTY is set to "A," the pack overheats faster than if it is set to "B." Similarly, if the RIGHT DIFFICULTY is set to "B" the pack will cool down faster than if it is set to "A."

Once an overheat condition occurs, the Neutrons Wand is inoperable until the pack completely cools. Overheating the pack results in an expensive repair (see SCORING), but it's better than a meltdown of the fuel cells!

P.K.E. INSTRUCTIONS

5. GHOST BEHAVIOR

"Sir, what you had there was what we refer to as a Focused, Non-Terminal, Repeating Phantasm, or a Class V Full-Roaming Vapor. A real nasty one, too." — Dr. Ray Stantz

Five classes of ghost are found in the library. They differ in colors and four characteristics:

- Strength: resistance to the Neutrons Wand's stream
- Temperament: fear of humans
- Movement: likelihood to change path
- Manifestation: duration of presence in a particular area

Class	Strength	Temperament	Movement	Manifestation
 I	Weak	Timid	Steady	Lingers
 II	Resilient	Skittish	Unsettled	Patient
 III	Formidable	Bold	Agitated	Restless
 IV	Intense	Erratic	Chaotic	Transient
 V	Relentless	Brazen	Possessed	Fleeting

P.K.E. INSTRUCTIONS

6. SNACK AND BONUS ITEMS

"Well, let's say this Twinkie represents the normal amount of psychokinetic energy in the New York area. Based on this morning's sample, it would be a Twinkie thirty-five feet long, weighing approximately six hundred pounds."

— Dr. Egon Spengler

Seven snack items and one very important book have been placed in the library. Collecting these will earn cash (see SCORING) and upgrades (see HOW TO USE THE P.K.E. METER).

Tier 1				Tier 2			Tier 3
							

Tier 1: Basic snacks include a ***pink donut***, a ***mug of coffee*** ("Yes, have some!"), an ***Ecto Cooler juice box***, and ***Cheez-It Crackers***.

Tier 2: Advanced snacks include the ***Nestlé Crunch bar*** ("You've earned it!"), ***Hostess Twinkie***, and a ***Stay-Puft marshmallow***.

Tier 3: The foundational reference book for any paranormal hunter, ***Tobin's Spirit Guide*** is the ultimate bonus prize.

P.K.E. INSTRUCTIONS

7. SCORING

"No job is too big, no fee is too big" — Dr. Peter Venkman

Ghost Trapping	
Ghost Class	Fee Earned
Class I	\$500
Class II	\$1,000
Class III	\$1,500
Class IV	\$2,500
Class V	\$5,000

Penalties	
Event	Repair Cost
Pack Overheats	\$1,000

Bonuses			
Item Found	Bonus Earned	Item Found	Bonus Earned
Pink Donut	\$250	Twinkie	\$500
Mug of Coffee	\$250	Stay-Puft Marshmallow	\$500
Ecto Cooler	\$250	Tobin's Spirit Guide	\$1,000
Cheez-It Crackers	\$250	Collect the snacks again	A clean uniform (or \$7,500)
Crunch Bar	\$500		

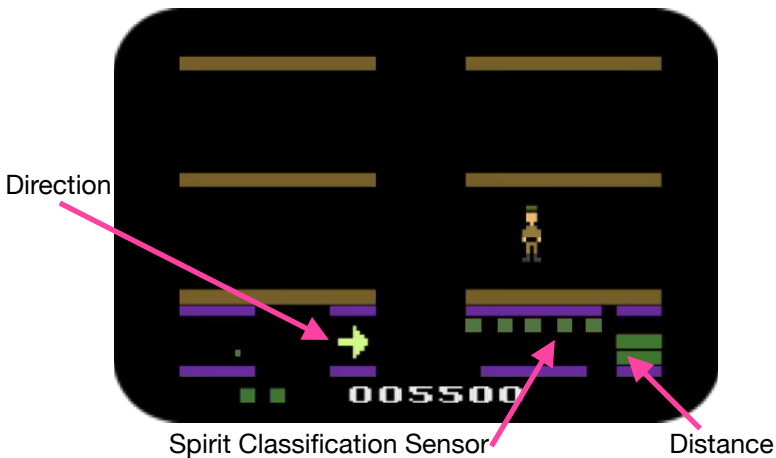
P.K.E. INSTRUCTIONS

8. HOW TO USE THE P.K.E. METER

"Spengler went down there and took some P.K.E. readings. Right off the top of the scale! Buried the needle!" — Dr. Ray Stantz

The Psychokinetic Energy (P.K.E.) Meter is the primary detection and ranging device to locate ghosts, and its readout takes up most of the bottom of the screen.

On the right side is the distance readout. The meter senses energy being given off by a paranormal entity. As paranormal energy increases, the meter becomes increasingly reactive. Beeps and lights indicate the range.



Additional features include the Spirit Classification Sensor and Direction Finder. These indicate the ghost's class by displaying one to five lights when you are within one screen of the ghost and the general direction to the ghost, and depending on the game variation, either are on from the start or after finding bonuses.

P.K.E. INSTRUCTIONS

Feedback	Meaning
	No audio The ghost is three or more screens away
	Slow blink and beep The ghost is two screens away
	Medium blink and beep The ghost is one screen away
	Fast blink and beep The ghost is on the screen.
	Indicates the Spirit Classification of ghost, from class I - class V
	The ghost is generally in this direction

In some Game Variations, the Spirit Classification Sensor is only available after finding 4 snacks, and the Direction finder is only available after reading Tobin's Spirit Guide.

9. GAME VARIATIONS

"Human sacrifice, dogs and cats living together... mass hysteria!"

— Dr. Peter Venkman

The difficulty ramps up depending on which of the sixteen game variations is played, based on these game elements:

Layout: The game will either be played in the Easy Layout (main level) or Complex Layout (basement).

Bonus Item Placement: Bonus items will either be placed in the same, predefined location, or randomly distributed for the first cycle. Note that once the Tobin's Spirit Guide has been found, the snacks will **always** be randomly placed.

Locator Map: The locator map will either be available or will remain off for play, requiring you to keep track of your location entirely by memory.

Advanced P.K.E. Functions: In some variations the Spirit Classification Sensor and Direction Finder will be available at the start of the game. In others you will only get the Spirit Classification Sensor after finding four snacks, and the Direction Finder after reading Tobin's Spirit Guide.

See the GAME SELECT MATRIX to determine which combination of options is turned on for a particular variation.

P.K.E. INSTRUCTIONS

10. HELPFUL HINTS

"Okay, important safety tip. Thanks, Egon." — Dr. Peter Venkman

Move closer after you stun the ghost. Your stream is more effective at weakening the ghost the closer you are.

Distance is as the ghost flies. The P.K.E. Distance Meter shows absolute distance. However, the ghost may be one screen diagonally, which takes moving two screens to get to.

Always have an escape strategy. If the ghost slimes you, you're out, so be ready if you need to run away and bust another day.

Whoa! Ho! Ho! Nice shootin', Tex... Reflected energy from hitting a wall will cause your pack to overheat even faster than normal.

When you're hot, you're hot! Ghosts become brave when they can tell your pack is disabled. Be careful.

Retrace your steps. All the bonus items are not visible at the start. They appear in a sequence. Only after locating the four tier 1 snacks will the tier 2 snacks be visible. Collect those, and you'll finally have a chance to read Tobin's Spirit Guide!

Keep Snacking! Finding the Spirit Guide completes your inventory, but your work isn't done. The seven snacks are spread through the library again. Find them again to earn either a clean uniform or (if you have the full complement) a cash bonus of **\$7,500**.

11. GAME SELECT MATRIX

Game No.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16
Main Level																
Basement																
Fixed Bonus Locations																
All PKE Functions available at start																
Advanced PKE functions require bonuses *																
Map Available																

* Spirit Classification Sensor after locating 4 snacks. Direction Finder after locating Tobin's Spirit Guide.

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